

MENGYING WU

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HARVARD
UNIVERSITY

Address	Belfer Center 317 79 John F. Kennedy St Cambridge MA 02138
Academic Appointments	Harvard University (2023 – Present) Postdoctoral Fellow, Environment and Natural Resources Program, Harvard Kennedy School Belfer Center & Salata Institute for Climate and Sustainability Carnegie Mellon University (2022 – 2023) Postdoctoral Associate, Department of Engineering and Public Policy Visiting Researcher, Institute of Energy, Environment, and Economy, Tsinghua University (Summer 2023)
Education	Massachusetts Institute of Technology , Institute for Data, Systems, and Society Ph.D. in Social and Engineering Systems, 2023 (defended September 2022) • Dissertation: <i>Local official and polluter accountability in China's environmental inspections</i> M.Fin., MIT Sloan School of Management (2017) Zhejiang University B.S. in Applied Mathematics (2011–2015)
Fields	Energy and Environmental Policy; Regulation and Policy Implementation <i>Methods</i> : equilibrium modeling; causal inference; text-as-data methods
Publications	Dynamic Responses of SO₂ Pollution to China's Environmental Inspections (with Valerie J. Karplus; co-first authors) [link] [code] <i>Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences</i> , 2023
Conditionally Accepted	Policy Interactions and the Cost of Decarbonizing Aviation (with Kristen McCormack, William A. Scott, Aaron Smith, Jingran Zhang, and James H. Stock) [link] [code] Conditionally accepted, <i>Journal of the Association of Environmental and Resource Economists</i> ; NBER Working Paper No. 34326. <i>Featured in</i> E&E News. <i>Policy impact</i> : analysis of California's proposed SAF tax credit with this model (Energy Institute at Haas, Feb. 2026) was cited by the California Legislative Analyst's Office. First author : designed the equilibrium model, carried out the calibration, coding, and empirical analysis, wrote the manuscript, and coordinated the research team.
Research in Progress	Do State Low Carbon Fuel Standards Complement Federal Biofuel Mandates? (with Kristen McCormack, William A. Scott, Aaron Smith, Jingran Zhang, and James H. Stock) Asks what state clean-fuel standards add to federal biofuel mandates and how a newly adopting state should design one; first author. <i>To be presented at the APPAM Fall Research Conference, 2026.</i> When Inspectors Return: Who Receives Substantive Enforcement? Asks how repeated central inspections change which firms receive substantive local enforcement; preliminary results from 80,000+ citizen complaint records in China. <i>Presented at the CU Environmental & Resource Economics Workshop, 2026.</i>

Dynamic Incentives and the Cost of Climate Policy in U.S. Transportation

Examines how credit banking and durable vehicle investment shape the timing, cost, and incidence of transportation decarbonization, using a dynamic national model of fuel, credit, and vehicle markets spanning road transportation and aviation, benchmarked against a carbon price.

Policy Writing

High Costs and Few Benefits from California’s Proposed Sustainable Aviation Fuel Tax Credit (with Aaron Smith, Kristen McCormack, William A. Scott, James H. Stock, and Jingran Zhang) [\[link\]](#)
Energy Institute at Haas Blog, February 2026; cited by the California Legislative Analyst’s Office.

Towards Credible and Cost-Effective Options for Sourcing Green Power for Supply Chains in China (with Da Zhang and Valerie J. Karplus) [\[link\]](#)
Policy brief for the Tsinghua Round Table on Corporate Carbon Neutrality Strategies, 2023.

Fellowships

MIT Presidential Fellowship, 2017
Salata Institute for Climate and Sustainability Postdoctoral Fellowship, Harvard University, 2023–2027

Teaching & Advising

Research supervision, Harvard University (2026 – Present)
Supervise undergraduate research assistants on the clean-fuel policy modeling project.
Research supervision, Carnegie Mellon University (2022 – 2023)
Supervised master’s research assistants on the Tsinghua green-power supply chain project (interview design, data collection, analysis).
Science, Technology and Public Policy, MIT (Spring 2020, Spring 2021)
Teaching Assistant for Professors Noelle Selin and Kenneth Oye; led weekly recitation sections (10–15 students), grading, and research-project mentoring.
The Economic Approach to Cities and Environmental Sustainability, MIT (Fall 2021)
Guest lecture: “Political Economy of Regulating Pollution”
MIT Kaufman Teaching Certificate Program, MIT (Fall 2020)
Designed course curriculum for “Data Science for Decision Making in Public Policy”.

Academic Presentations

2027 ASSA Annual Meeting, poster (scheduled)

2026 APPAM Fall Research Conference (scheduled); Tsinghua University; CU Environmental & Resource Economics Workshop; University of Hong Kong; Hong Kong University of Science and Technology; ARCS Research Conference; Renmin University of China; China and Energy Fellows Seminar, Belfer Center; Fudan University; Huazhong University of Science and Technology; Institutional and Organizational Economics Academy; CES NA Annual Conference

2024 ASSA Annual Meeting

2023 ARCS Annual Research Conference

2022 Northeast Workshop on Energy Policy and Environmental Economics

2020–21 Environmental Politics and Governance Conference; Duck Family Graduate Workshop in Environmental Politics and Governance (2020, 2021); Institutional and Organizational Economics Academy; ETH Academy on Sustainability and Technology; China Research Group Doctoral Symposium; Interdisciplinary Ph.D. Workshop in Sustainable Development

Policy & Industry Presentations

2026 North American SAF Conference and Expo; International Fuel Ethanol Workshop & Expo

2025 Regional SAF Workshop for Massachusetts and New England

2024 North American SAF Conference and Expo
 2023 Roundtable on Corporate Carbon Neutrality Strategies, Tsinghua University

Service Referee: *GCB Bioenergy*
 Student organizer, Sloan China Seminar Series, MIT (2017–2020)
 Research Collaborator, Sustainable PPE Initiative, MIT (2020–2021)

Languages English (fluent), Chinese (native)

Software skills Python, GAMS, Stata, R, MATLAB, $\text{\LaTeX}$

References

Professor James H. Stock Harvard Department of Economics 79 John F. Kennedy St, Belfer 504 Cambridge, MA 02138 james_stock@harvard.edu	Professor Valerie Karplus CMU Department of Engineering and Public Policy 5123 Scott Hall, 5000 Forbes Ave Pittsburgh, PA 15213 vkarplus@andrew.cmu.edu
Professor Aaron Smith UC Berkeley Department of Agricultural and Resource Economics 207 Giannini Hall Berkeley, CA 94720 AaronSmith@berkeley.edu	